S T R A T E G Y B L U E P R I N T

DevReady Product & Growth Master Plan

Strategy for becoming the #1 interview-prep platform for Persian-speaking developers

Prepared for: DevReady Founding Team

Scope: Product · Content · Growth · Monetization

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1. Executive Summary

DevReady today is a genuinely differentiated product sitting on an under-exploited asset. It ships 636+ hand-curated resources across 32 categories, fully bilingual in English and Persian with production-quality RTL support, a local-first progress system (bookmarks, in-progress, completed, personal notes) that requires no account, a Daily Challenge with progressive hints and streak tracking, a spaced-repetition Review Deck, and a multi-stage Roadmap with role paths and a weekly rhythm. No competitor combines this breadth with a native Persian experience. At the same time, the product has three structural constraints: there is no telemetry (so retention cannot currently be measured or managed), progress is trapped in the browser (so switching devices loses users), and most value is one click away on external sites (so the daily habit loop leaks).

This plan is built on three strategic bets. **Bet 1 — the Persian-first moat:** GreatFrontEnd, NeetCode, roadmap.sh and the rest of the English-speaking competitive set will not plausibly invest in native, Persian-written content and RTL product craft. DevReady should own that entire stack — content corpus, community, and brand — while remaining strong in English. **Bet 2 — the local-to-account flywheel:** keep anonymous local mode as a first-class, never-coerced experience, and let optional accounts unlock sync, opt-in analytics, personalization, and paid intelligence. Trust is the wedge, not lock-in. **Bet 3 — the hybrid content engine:** curation wins breadth cheaply; original interactive content (a bilingual question bank, native digest cards, in-browser exercises) wins retention and defensibility. Every external link gains a native layer over time.

The sequencing logic is measure, activate, retain, then monetize. Privacy-friendly analytics ship first because none of the targets below can be managed before they can be measured. A quick-win pack (Next Best Action card, onboarding quiz, shareable progress card) lands within four weeks. Accounts and cloud sync land by the end of month three. The original question bank and the Pro tier launch together in months three to six, because paid value should coincide with the arrival of original interactive content. AI mock interviews and B2B follow in the second half once data and content support them.

Table 1. Headline 12-month targets (illustrative — to be re-based against the analytics baseline established in month 1).

Metric	Definition	12-month target	Why it matters
North star: Weekly Active Preppers	Users completing 3+ prep actions in a rolling week	Baseline in M1; +20% quarter over quarter	Counts habit, not visits

Metric	Definition	12-month target	Why it matters
Activation rate	New users who bookmark 1+ resource, complete 1 resource and finish 1 Daily Challenge in their first session	35% or higher	First-session value predicts D30
Day-7 retention	Share of new users returning 7 days after first session	18%+ (typical baseline: ~8%)	Proves the daily loop works
Day-30 retention	Share returning at day 30	10%+ (typical baseline: ~3.5%)	Prep cycles last 8–16 weeks
Streak persistence	Activated users with a 7-day-or-longer streak	25%+	Streaks are the habit anchor
Resource completion rate	Started resources marked completed	40%+	Curation must convert to progress
Free-to-Pro conversion	Paying accounts over active accounts	2–4%	Sustains the small team

What this plan deliberately does not do: it does not pivot the product, add social feeds, bolt on a mobile app prematurely, or paywall the library. The calm, local-first, no-dark-patterns identity is the differentiator; every recommendation below either compounds it or carefully extends it. Sections 8 and 7.1 are the immediately actionable core: a founding team can start on Section 8 the next working day.

2. Product Vision & Positioning

2.1 Positioning Statement

Positioning statement: “DevReady is the structured, bilingual home base that turns interview preparation from scattered internet chaos into one guided daily path — in English and Persian.” Every word is load-bearing. “Home base” claims the hub position against link-farms and single-purpose question banks. “Structured” and “daily path” claim the guidance position against raw catalogs. “Bilingual” and “Persian” claim a market the entire competitive set currently ignores. The short version for packaging and community channels: “Prepare properly. In your language.”

2.2 User Personas

Primary persona — Amir, 26, mid-level frontend developer in Tehran. Amir has three years of experience at a local product company, reads English documentation daily but thinks in Persian, and earns a fraction of what his counterparts make abroad, so remote and relocation roles are his real prize. He is disciplined but time-starved: he studies in the

evening after work, mostly on one laptop, and his interview window is typically 8–16 weeks away. His pains are concrete: quality resources are scattered across English blogs, Telegram channels and YouTube; he cannot tell which of 40 React articles is actually interview-grade; and no tool remembers what he has already covered when he switches browsers. He wants a plan he can trust and a daily answer to "what should I do tonight?" DevReady's local-first bookmarking, Daily Challenge, and Persian explanations speak directly to him — and optional sync removes his biggest anxiety: losing months of progress.

Table 2. Persona map. Primary and secondary personas drive roadmap order; tertiary personas ride along.

Persona	Profile	Core pains	What they need from DevReady
Amir — Persian-speaking dev in Iran	Mid-level FE/full-stack, Tehran or Mashhad, targets remote or relocation, evening studier	Resource chaos; no guidance; progress lost across devices; no Persian-first material; cannot pay for foreign subscriptions easily	Guided roadmap, Daily Challenge habit loop, Persian-language depth, sync, regional-friendly pricing
Sara — diaspora bootcamp grad	Persian-speaking junior in Berlin or Toronto, switched careers, first job hunt underway	Impostor syndrome; English-only prep feels twice as hard; needs structure more than content	Bilingual reassurance, role paths, behavioral question bank, certificates of progress to share
Ethan — English-speaking career switcher	25–35, non-CS background, uses roadmap.sh and free handbooks today	Overwhelmed by choices; wants one curated path with progress tracking and no account nagging	Free structured roadmap, local-first tracking, clean dark-mode UX; converts to Pro only if AI features prove value
Neda — bootcamp operator (B2B)	Runs a 30–100 student cohort at a bootcamp or community program	No visibility into who is actually preparing; wants credible curriculum and reporting	Cohort dashboards, curriculum mapping, readiness export; a per-seat license decision

Two behavioral notes matter more than the demographics. First, Persian-speaking developers are heavy Telegram users; community distribution (Section 5.3) must be Telegram-first, not Twitter-first. Second, both Amir and Sara exhibit "progress anxiety" — the fear of losing accumulated study state. Local-first design created this trust; cloud sync (Section 3.2) converts it into accounts, which is the single highest-leverage product move in this plan.

2.3 Competitive Landscape and Unique Value Proposition

The market divides into four archetypes: question banks (LeetCode, GreatFrontEnd), video course libraries (NeetCode), roadmaps (roadmap.sh), and free handbooks (Frontend Interview Handbook). All of them are English-first; none treats Persian speakers as a primary audience; none is local-first; and none couples a curation catalog with a daily habit loop. Pricing below was verified in October 2026 against public pricing pages.

Table 3. Competitor snapshot (public pricing verified October 2026) and the gap DevReady exploits.

Platform	Focus and model	Verified pricing (Oct 2026)	Gap DevReady exploits
GreatFrontEnd	500+ frontend questions, in-browser coding, prep plans by ex-interviewers	$39/mo; $120/yr; $180 lifetime	High price point; English-only; no daily habit loop; no Persian content
NeetCode Pro	DSA video courses, 300+ problems, AI hints (NeetBot), company tags, cloud sync	$119/yr; $297 lifetime	DSA-centric and Python-first; thin web-dev breadth; English-only; no curation layer
roadmap.sh	Community role roadmaps and guides; sponsorship-funded	Free	Breadth without depth: no question bank, no tracking depth, no structured prep loop
Frontend Interview Handbook	Free static handbook content funneling to GreatFrontEnd	Free	Static reading only; no interactivity, tracking, or personalization
Exponent	SWE/PM interview prep with mocks; consumer plus B2B plans	Subscription (consumer and company tiers)	Generalist and comparatively expensive; English-only; enterprise feel rather than learner-calm

The unique value proposition is therefore a combination, not a single feature: (a) native Persian and RTL product craft with a فارسی-only filter; (b) a free 636-resource curated library that competitors would need months to match; (c) a genuine habit loop — Daily Challenge with progressive hints, streaks, and a spaced-repetition Review Deck; and (d) local-first privacy as an identity, not a limitation. Against a price leader like GreatFrontEnd, DevReady Pro can launch under half the price while the free tier already delivers what competitors gate. Against NeetCode, DevReady covers the full web-development interview surface — including behavioral, system design, and job-hunt skills that DSA course libraries ignore.

2.4 Brand Personality and Emotional Promise

The brand is “the trusted senior friend who already passed the interview.” That person is calm, precise, encouraging, and allergic to hype. In a regional course market cluttered with

inflated “guaranteed job” promises, restraint is a competitive weapon: DevReady never sells certainty, always shows the work, and treats learners as adults. The emotional promise is: **“You are not behind. You are on the path.”** Interview preparation is emotionally expensive — anxiety, comparison, imposter feelings — and a product that lowers that temperature daily will be used daily.

Voice rules follow from the personality:

- **We say:** “Here is a model answer, and here is why it works” — show reasoning, cite sources, admit difficulty.
- **We never say:** “Guaranteed offer,” “crush it in 7 days,” or fake urgency counters.
- **Bilingual craft:** Persian is written natively by engineers, never machine-translated; technical terms stay in English inside Persian prose, matching how real Iranian developers actually talk.
- **Dark-mode-first calm:** the existing light/dark design system, generous whitespace and Aceternity-style accents stay; retention mechanics must feel like encouragement, not manipulation.

> **Brand in one line**
>
> Structured, bilingual, honest. The calm alternative to interview-prep anxiety — and the only serious one built for Persian speakers from day one.

3. Core Product Improvements (Next 3–6 Months)

3.1 Prioritized Backlog: Impact vs. Effort

The backlog below is ranked for a small team (one full-time founding engineer, one part-time engineer, one part-time native content lead). Impact scores weight retention and account-flywheel effects above polish; effort is calibrated so that 5 represents a full quarter of team capacity. Everything rated “Must” lands within six months; “Should” items start within the window and may finish after it; “Nice” items are consciously deferred, not forgotten.

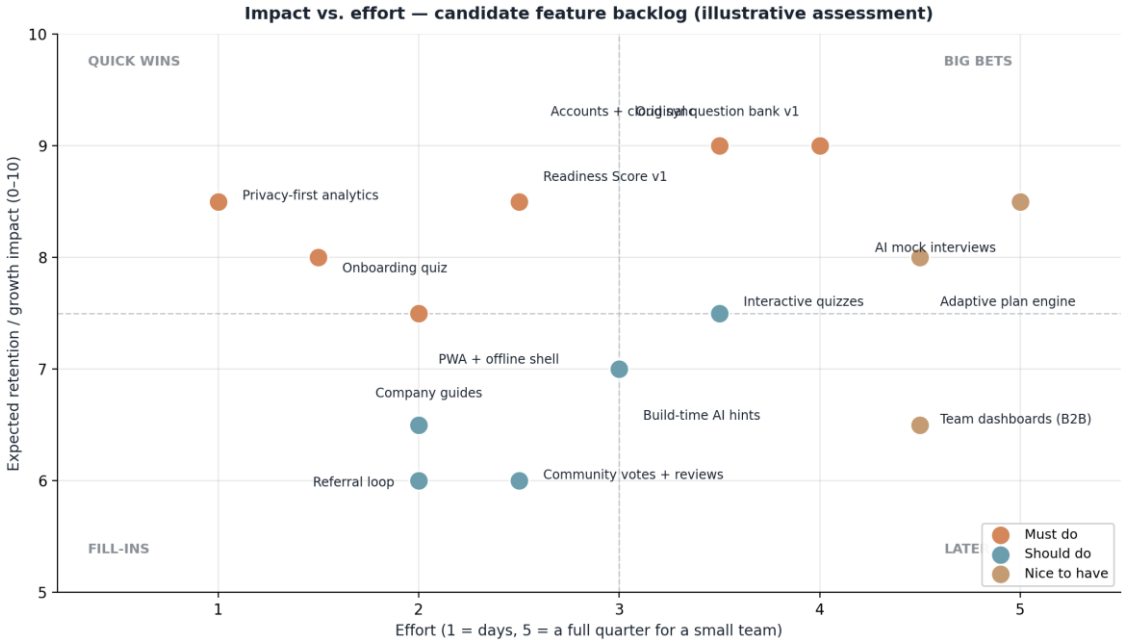


Figure 1. Impact vs. effort assessment of the candidate backlog (illustrative scoring by the founding team; quadrant thresholds at effort 3 and impact 7.5).

Table 4. Prioritized feature backlog with rationale. Priority labels: Must / Should / Nice.

Feature	Priority	Impact	Effort	Rationale
Privacy-first analytics (aggregate, opt-in)	**Must**	8.5	1.0	Nothing can be managed before it is measured; feeds every later decision
Next Best Action + onboarding quiz	**Must**	8.0	1.5	Converts existing local data into a guided first session and daily answer
Interview Readiness Score v1	**Must**	8.5	2.5	A single progress number drives return visits; spec in Appendix B
PWA install + offline shell	**Must**	7.5	2.0	Habit products live on the home screen; enables reminders later
Accounts + privacy-first cloud sync	**Must**	9.0	3.5	Unlocks multi-device retention, opt-in analytics, and all future revenue
Original bilingual question bank v1 (100 questions)	**Must**	9.0	4.0	Retention asset and Pro anchor; feeds Daily Challenge and AI layers
Build-time AI hints and summaries	**Should**	7.0	3.0	AI value with zero runtime API cost; preserves local-first architecture
Interactive quizzes per resource	**Should**	7.5	3.5	Turns reading into practice; measurable completion lift
Company guides (10, bilingual)	**Should**	6.5	2.0	High-intent SEO traffic and community sharing

Feature	Priority	Impact	Effort	Rationale
Community votes and short reviews	**Should**	6.0	2.5	Signals quality; builds contribution habit ahead of UGC scale
Referral loop (give-get)	**Should**	6.0	2.0	Compounding organic growth on top of shareable artifacts
AI mock interviews (runtime)	Nice	8.5	5.0	Pro anchor for year 2; requires accounts scale and cost controls first
Adaptive plan engine	Nice	8.0	4.5	Needs months of behavioral data before it can beat the static roadmap
Team dashboards (B2B)	Nice	6.5	4.5	Real revenue channel, but premature before consumer Pro validates

3.2 User Accounts and Privacy-First Cloud Sync

Accounts exist to serve the user, never to trap them. The design principle is anonymous-first: every feature works without an account today and must keep working after accounts ship. Sign-up uses an email magic link (no password storage, minimal surface), or Google/GitHub OAuth as convenience options. Account creation is offered at moments of felt need — after a first bookmark ("keep this safe across devices?"), after a 7-day streak ("protect your streak"), and before clearing browser data — never as an interstitial wall.

Sync merges, it does not overwrite. On login, the local state is pushed and merged server-side with per-key rules, so a user who studied on two devices loses nothing. Conflicts resolve by newest timestamp for scalar values (progress state per resource), set-union for collections (bookmarks, tags), and tombstones for deletions so an item deleted on one device does not resurrect from another. The full merge walkthrough is in Appendix A.2.

Table 5. Local storage keys (current schema) and their cloud-sync merge rule.

Data (localStorage key family)	Contents	Merge rule on sync
Bookmarks	Resource IDs saved by the user	Union of both sets; deletes recorded as tombstones
Progress (in-progress / completed)	Per-resource status and timestamps	Newest timestamp wins per resource; completion never regresses
Personal notes	Per-resource rich text	Field-level newest-wins; append history kept 30 days for recovery

Data (localStorage key family)	Contents	Merge rule on sync
Daily Challenge history and streak	Completions, current streak, freezes	Union of completion days; streak = longest active derivation
Review Deck schedule	Spaced-repetition card due dates	Newest schedule wins per card
Resource votes	Difficulty votes cast	Last vote wins per resource
Preferences	Language, theme, motion settings	Explicit user choice wins; defaults never overwrite

Privacy commitments, stated publicly on a plain-language page:

- **Aggregate-only telemetry, opt-in.** Counts and funnels, never keystrokes or page dumps; the anonymous default stays fully functional.
- **One-click JSON export of everything** (bookmarks, progress, notes, challenge history) — the export the local-first design already implies, now portable.
- **Hard delete.** “Delete my account” purges server data within 24 hours and hands back a local export.
- **No ads, no data sale, no third-party trackers** — stated in the same sentence as the pricing page, because in this market trust is marketing.

3.3 Personalization and Adaptive Learning

The current Roadmap (nine stages, role paths, weekly rhythm) is the skeleton; personalization makes it feel alive. Version 1 is rule-based and ships quickly: an onboarding quiz (target role, timeline, self-rated strengths, hours per week) selects the role path, reorders roadmap emphasis, and seeds the Review Deck. From that moment the home screen leads with a Next Best Action card computed from local state alone: due Review Deck cards first, then the Daily Challenge, then the next incomplete roadmap item, then an in-progress resource. One card, one primary button, in the user's language — this is the daily answer to “what now?” that turns a catalog into a coach.

The Interview Readiness Score (0–100) is the emotional engine of personalization; its full specification is Appendix B. In short, it combines roadmap completion, challenge accuracy trend, review discipline, practice performance and consistency into one number the user can watch climb. A genuinely adaptive engine (reordering content by weakness, ETAs, difficulty targeting) is a 6–12 month project that requires the behavioral data accounts provide; it is deliberately scheduled as “Nice” in the backlog because a rules-based system plus honest scores beats a premature algorithm nobody trusts.

3.4 Interactive Content Layer

Curation brought breadth; interactivity creates time-on-product and completion. Four formats are planned in order of build priority. **First, checkpoint quizzes:** three to five curated multiple-choice questions attached to top resources, gated on completion, feeding the Review Deck with missed items. **Second, the bilingual question bank:** 100 original questions in year one with model answers, difficulty ratings, and progressive hints — the same hint ladder users already know from the Daily Challenge. **Third, in-browser exercises:** small JavaScript and React tasks executed in a sandboxed iframe against visible test assertions; no backend judge is required for the v1 scope, which keeps cost near zero. **Fourth, notes-to-flashcards:** a one-tap conversion of a user's own note into a Review Deck card, closing the loop between personal notes and spaced repetition.

Every external link also gains a native "digest card" — a 200–400 word DevReady-written summary with the key takeaways rendered in-app (details in Section 4.1). The digest card is the bridge between curation and original content: the user gets value even before clicking out, and DevReady accumulates an original corpus as a side effect of maintaining quality.

3.5 AI Features Roadmap

AI is sequenced so that cost and architecture stay compatible with a local-first, small-team product. The key insight: build-time AI — generating hints, summaries, distractors and translations offline and shipping them as static content — delivers most learner value at zero marginal inference cost and keeps the product fully functional offline and in restricted-network regions. Runtime AI (live mock interviews) arrives only with Pro revenue, hard rate limits, and accounts infrastructure behind it.

Table 6. AI roadmap. Build-time features ship as static content; runtime features are Pro-tier and rate-limited.

Phase	Feature	User value	Cost control	Tier
A1	Pre-generated hints per question (3-step ladders) and per-resource summaries/digest cards	Always-available scaffolding; value before the click-out	Generated at build time; stored in repo; zero runtime cost	Free
A2	Smart recommendations: embedding similarity between user gaps (missed topics) and catalog	"Because you missed X, study Y next"	Monthly batch re-embedding; retrieval runs client-side or on edge	Free

Phase	Feature	User value	Cost control	Tier
B	AI mock interview: chat-based questioning with rubric-structured feedback (correctness, complexity, communication)	Realistic practice without scheduling a partner	Runtime LLM with hard monthly quotas; cached rubrics; small-model routing	Pro
C	Persian-language answer evaluation	The only tool that scores Persian technical answers — unique dataset and moat	Fine-tuned evaluation on accumulated bilingual answers; batch analysis	Pro

A regional constraint becomes an architectural advantage here. Sanctions and network restrictions make direct third-party AI API access unreliable for Iran-based users; because Phases A1/A2 are build-time, Persian-speaking users get AI-derived value with no dependency on runtime access, and Phase B/C runtime features are later served through the same regional partner infrastructure used for payments (Section 6.3). Where competitors must bolt AI onto an account-required architecture, DevReady's local-first stack absorbs it without breaking its identity.

3.6 Gamification and Retention Systems

DevReady already has the right skeleton — Daily Challenge streaks, progress states, and the Review Deck. The evolution is Streak 2.0: two streak freezes per month (earnable via the referral loop and quiz milestones, not only purchasable), milestone badges at 7/30/100 days, and a personal study-year heatmap. A weekly recap — “three resources completed, four challenges solved, streak saved once” — lands as a local PWA notification on Monday mornings, opt-in, in the user's language. Milestone certificates (bilingual, shareable, verifiable by URL once accounts exist) mark roadmap-stage completions; these are the artifacts users post, which feeds the growth loops in Section 5.1. The tonal rule from Section 2.4 applies to every mechanic: encouragement, never manipulation — no countdown timers, no loss-framed nagging, no red badges.

3.7 Lightweight Community and Social Features

Community features are sequenced moderation-cheapest first. Ship order: difficulty votes (infrastructure already specified in the Phase 5 work), one-click broken-link reporting, short structured reviews (“I used this for X company — worked / outdated” limited to 280 characters), contributor credits on resource cards for accepted Suggest-a-Resource entries, and reviewer badges for trusted contributors who pass a quality audit. Comment threads and direct messages are deliberately deferred: they carry meaningful moderation cost and

safety exposure that a small bilingual team should not adopt in year one. The credit system is the real lever — Persian-speaking developers visibly credited as contributors become the product's most credible advocates (Section 5.1, loop 4).

3.8 Mobile Experience and PWA Strategy

A native app is not on the 12-month roadmap, and that is a decision, not an omission. The path is an installable PWA: web app manifest, service worker with an offline shell (catalog, roadmap, notes, and Review Deck work offline by design; progress syncs when online), an install prompt surfaced after the second session, and opt-in local notifications for streak rescue and review-due reminders. This covers roughly the whole daily loop on Android and desktop, and most of it on iOS within Apple's constraints. RTL is already first-class in the design system, so no separate mobile RTL audit is needed. A wrapped native app (Capacitor or similar) is revisited only after D30 retention exceeds 10% and the notification funnel proves it can move that number — otherwise it would add distribution cost to a habit that is not yet proven.

> **The six-month product thesis**
>
> Measure honestly, guide every session with local data, secure progress in the cloud behind trust, and start earning original content. Everything else in this plan compounds from those four moves.

4. Content Strategy

4.1 Reducing External-Link Dependency and Defeating Link Rot

A 636-link catalog is an asset with a half-life. At the industry's typical link-rot rate of roughly 6–10% per year, DevReady should expect 40–60 dead or degraded links annually without an active defense — invisible today precisely because there is no telemetry. The maintenance system has four parts, all cheap to build: a monthly automated HTTP audit across the entire catalog that records status codes and flags redirects, soft-404s and slow responses; automatic Wayback Machine snapshot checks with an “archived version” fallback link when a live URL degrades; a one-click “broken link” report on every resource card routed into the existing Suggest-a-Resource triage queue; and a freshness badge (reviewed date) on each resource card so users can see the catalog is alive.

Dependency on destinations is reduced by the digest-card program: for each of the top 100 resources by usage, a DevReady-written 200–400 word summary with key takeaways, rendered natively in the app above the outbound link, in both languages. If a destination dies or changes, the summary preserves the value and the slot is re-curated rather than abandoned. Digest cards also serve the interactive layer (Section 3.4), the AI hint corpus

(Section 3.5), and Persian SEO (Section 5.2) — one writing investment, four returns. The program starts with 10 cards per week and reaches 100 in a quarter.

4.2 Original Content Roadmap: What to Create First, and Why

Original content is prioritized by a single rule: create the asset that increases daily return probability and cannot be found elsewhere in Persian. The sequence below is sized for one part-time native content lead plus founder editing time, with each item strengthening the product loop rather than merely adding pages.

Table 7. Original content roadmap in build order. Every item ships bilingual unless marked Persian-first.

Order	Asset	Why this order	Scope	Primary job
1	Bilingual question bank v1: 100 questions (JS, React, behavioral) with model answers and hint ladders	Feeds Daily Challenge, Review Deck and Pro tier at once; the single highest-leverage asset	100 × (question + model answer + 3 hints)	Retention and monetization anchor
2	Digest cards for top 100 resources	Maintains curation quality while accumulating original text; cheap per unit	100 × 200–400 words × 2 languages	Link-rot defense and SEO
3	10 company guides (bilingual)	High-intent searches; strong sharing loop among referral circles	10 guides, 1,500 words each	Acquisition
4	Persian-first system design primer series	No credible Persian equivalent exists; premium-feeling free content builds brand	8 parts, Persian-written	Brand and moat
5	Salary and negotiation guide (Iran market + remote/diaspora)	Unique, highly shared, deeply useful; nobody else covers both markets honestly	1 long-form + templates	Word-of-mouth
6	Relocation and visa guide for Persian developers	Emotionally resonant, evergreen, differentiating; pairs with persona Amir's real goal	1 long-form, updated quarterly	Word-of-mouth
7	Interactive JS fundamentals exercises	Converts readers into practitioners; uses the sandboxed runner from Section 3.4	30 exercises	Retention and completion

4.3 The Persian Content Advantage as a Real Moat

The advantage is only a moat if Persian content is written natively, not translated. Translated English content reads like a second-class mirror, and the audience can tell instantly; the style guide therefore mandates Persian-written explanations where Persian is the teaching language, with technical terms deliberately kept in English (exactly how Iranian developers speak), a shared glossary of Persian technical terminology to keep 636 resources and all new content consistent, and RTL typographic rules already enforced in the product. The فارسی-only filter currently surfaces 14 native-language resources; the goal is 150+ genuinely Persian-written items within 12 months, which would make DevReady's corpus larger than any competitor's Persian offering — by a factor of ten.

The moat compounds in three directions. SEO: the Persian keyword space (Section 5.2) is low-competition; the first structured entrant owns it. Data: Persian technical Q&A text feeds the Phase C AI evaluation model that no English-first competitor can replicate without hiring native engineers. Brand: being the only platform that respects Persian developers in their own language earns a trust premium that price cuts cannot dislodge. Afghan Persian (Dari) and Tajik audiences extend the addressable market at near-zero marginal content cost and are explicitly in scope for the keyword strategy.

4.4 Quality Control, Curation Standards, and Ongoing Maintenance

Curation is the product; it needs an auditable standard, not vibes. Every candidate resource — whether found by the team or submitted via Suggest-a-Resource — is scored against the six-criterion rubric below by two reviewers, with a third as tie-breaker. Acceptance requires at least 8 of 12 points and no zero on accuracy. Existing resources are re-reviewed on a rolling quarterly cycle, and any resource failing two consecutive re-reviews is de-listed to a visible archive rather than silently removed.

Table 8. Curation rubric (0–2 per criterion; acceptance bar: 8/12 with no zero on accuracy).

Criterion	0 points	1 point	2 points
Accuracy	Outdated or wrong on core claims	Mostly correct, minor staleness	Current and technically precise
Pedagogy	Dumps information; no structure	Explains but assumes too much	Builds understanding step by step
Interview signal	General interest only	Occasionally interview-relevant	Directly mapped to real interview loops
Language quality	Poor writing or translation artifacts	Acceptable but uneven	Excellent; native-level craft
Effort-to-value	Long with little payoff	Fair ratio	High value per minute invested

Criterion	0 points	1 point	2 points
Accessibility	No captions/transcripts where needed; hostile markup	Partial accommodations	Readable structure, captions, keyboard-friendly

Community contributions plug into the same rubric with a service-level promise: every Suggest-a-Resource submission is triaged within 48 hours and accepted submissions credit the contributor on the resource card. Quarterly, the team publishes a short “state of the catalog” note — additions, removals, dead links repaired — turning unglamorous maintenance into a public trust ritual.

4.5 Content Formats That Drive Retention

Formats are chosen by their measured effect on completion and return, not by production fashion. The retention stack in priority order: personal notes (already shipped — the strongest ownership signal a learner can create); the Review Deck (already shipped — converts consumed content into scheduled practice); the question bank with hint ladders (Chapter 4.2 item 1); checkpoint quizzes attached to resources; checklists (per-interview-type packing lists: what to revise, what to prepare, what to ask); and mock-interview scripts with timing guidance for pairs of users preparing simultaneously. Each format ships with an explicit completion metric from day one — notes created per active user, review-due discipline, question-bank accuracy — so the content roadmap stays accountable to behavior rather than output volume. Long-form guides are treated as acquisition surfaces (SEO, community sharing); short interactive artifacts are treated as retention surfaces. The two are measured separately and neither is judged by the other's metric.

5. Growth & Marketing Strategy

5.1 Organic Growth Loops Built Into the Product

Paid acquisition is out of scope for year one; the growth engine is a set of product-built loops, each with a trigger, a mechanism, and a measurable expectation. The unifying principle: DevReady manufactures shareable artifacts of effort — progress cards, badges, credits — because a studier's network is full of exactly the people who need the product. All artifacts render bilingually and RTL-correctly, since a Persian-language screenshot shared in a Telegram group is itself the ad.

Table 9. Product-built growth loops and their design.

Loop	Trigger	Mechanism	Expected effect
1. Shareable progress card	Weekly recap or milestone reached	One-tap bilingual image (readiness score, streak, stage completed) with a personalized invite link	Peer credibility; each cohort of sharers seeds new first sessions
2. Readiness badge	User opts in to a public profile	Permanent profile URL showing roadmap progress and verified badges; linked from resumes and bios	Long-tail backlinks; hiring-manager discovery (Section 6.4)
3. Challenge-a-friend	Daily Challenge completed	"Nudge a friend to beat today's challenge" with deep link; both get a streak freeze on acceptance	Direct viral k-factor on the daily habit
4. Contributor credits	Suggestion accepted or review published	Named credit on the resource card + contributor profile; contributors share their own credits	UGC supply growth with zero paid incentive
5. Company guide backlinks	Guide pages rank and get shared	Guides end with "prepare for this company" roadmap deep link	SEO-to-product conversion path
6. Open-source question seeds	Quarterly batch of 10 questions released on GitHub	Community translates/extends; repo links back with structured attribution	Developer credibility; inbound contributor funnel

5.2 Content Marketing and SEO Strategy

SEO is a two-language strategy with asymmetric economics: English clusters face entrenched competition, Persian clusters are nearly unclaimed. The technical foundation is already favorable — the site is server-rendered Next.js — and needs hreflang EN/FA pairing, FAQPage structured data on question pages, and one canonical URL per concept in each language. Content types per cluster: a pillar guide (3,000+ words), 10–20 question pages with model answers, and one original data piece per year (for example, a Persian developer job-market snapshot) that earns links.

Table 10. Bilingual SEO topic clusters. Persian terms are actual head terms targeted by the Persian cluster pages.

Cluster	Lang.	Representative head terms	Primary assets
Frontend interview prep	EN	frontend interview questions; react interview questions and answers	Pillar guide + question pages (from the 100-question bank)
System design	EN	system design interview prep; frontend system design	Primer series + roadmap deep links

Cluster	Lang.	Representative head terms	Primary assets
Job-hunt skills	EN	developer resume tips; behavioral interview questions software engineer	Guides 5–6 + checklist assets
آمادگی مصاحبه	FA	آمادگی مصاحبه برنامه‌نویسی; سوالات مصاحبه فرانت اند	Persian pillar guide + 100 bilingual question pages
طراحی سیستم	FA	طراحی سیستم; آموزش مصاحبه تخنیکی	Persian-first primer series (content item 4)
استخدام و رواددد	FA	رزومه برنامه‌نویس; مشاوره کاری برنامه‌نویس	Salary/negotiation and relocation guides

Cadence and measurement: two long-form pieces and six question pages per month at steady state, with Persian and English alternating weeks until the content lead is full-time. Cluster success is judged by positions on the head terms above, impressions-to-first-session conversion, and — critically — whether organic entrants activate (Section 1 table) better than other channels; clusters that acquire well but do not activate get pruned, not endlessly expanded.

5.3 Persian Tech Community Playbook (Telegram, X, LinkedIn, YouTube)

Persian-speaking developers live on Telegram; every other channel is secondary for that audience. The playbook is a fixed weekly cadence per channel, executable by the founder plus one community-savvy part-time helper, and it front-loads giving: prep tips, honest takes, and free tools before any product ask. English-speaking audiences are reached through the founder's build-in-public presence and the open-source artifacts rather than a dedicated content treadmill.

Table 11. Channel playbook with first-90-days cadence. Telegram is the primary Persian surface.

Channel	Role	Cadence	First 90 days
Telegram (own FA channel)	Daily habit anchor and community home	Daily	Daily Challenge crosspost at a fixed hour; 2 partner-channel collaborations per month; first monthly voice AMA in week 6
Telegram (partner channels)	Borrowed reach inside existing dev communities	Weekly	Map 20 viable Persian dev channels; 2–3 content collaborations per month (prep threads, challenge takeovers)
X / Twitter	EN + FA build-in-public; founder credibility	3–4 posts/week	Ship-log threads; share user milestones (with permission); engage EN interview-prep community

Channel	Role	Cadence	First 90 days
LinkedIn	Diaspora professionals; B2B visibility for bootcamps	2 posts/week	Persian+English bilingual posts; cohort partnership announcements; hiring-manager content
YouTube	Persian mock-interview breakdowns; trust through faces	2 videos/month	“Real mock interview, real feedback” Persian episodes; shorts cut from Daily Challenge explanations
GitHub	Developer credibility; contributor funnel	Quarterly	Open question-seed releases (loop 6); public catalog-change log

Community trust rules are non-negotiable and mirror the brand: no fake urgency, no engagement bait, every claim of a user milestone verifiable. The monthly voice AMA doubles as research — recurring questions become question-bank entries, closing the loop between community and content. Success metrics: own-channel growth rate, challenge-participation rate from channel posts (tracked via deep links), and qualitative sentiment in partner communities; subscriber counts are explicitly a vanity metric here.

5.4 Partnerships and Distribution Channels

Partnerships focus on organizations that already aggregate Persian-speaking learners. Targets in priority order: Iranian coding bootcamps and competitive-programming platforms (for example Quera and Maktab Sharif cohort programs) for curriculum partnerships; diaspora tech communities and retraining programs (for example ReDI School-type organizations in Europe) for workshop collaborations; university career clubs inside Iran for exam-season prep weeks; and relocation agencies serving Persian-speaking engineers for the relocation guide's distribution. The partnership product is co-branded prep weeks: a two-week guided plan built from the existing roadmap stages and Daily Challenge, white-labeled for the partner's cohort, with a shared readiness dashboard for cohort leads (the B2B pilot of Section 6.4). Each partnership is structured to be revenue-positive or learning-positive; free logo swaps are declined.

5.5 Referral and Viral Mechanics

The referral system converts the brand's natural word-of-mouth into a measured loop once accounts exist. Mechanics: every account gets a personal invite link; when a friend activates (per the Section 1 definition), both sides receive a streak freeze; at 3 successful invites the referrer earns a month of Pro; at 5, a lifetime 30% discount on the annual plan. Rewards are deliberately habit-aligned (streak protection) rather than cash, keeping cost

near zero and self-selection high. The shareable progress card and challenge-a-friend loops (5.1) act as the referral program's upper funnel; the K-factor target is 0.15 by month 9 — modest, compounding, and measured from the analytics baseline rather than claimed.

5.6 Launch and Ongoing Distribution Playbook

The launch is a coordinated bilingual moment, not a single Product Hunt spike. T-minus 4 weeks: analytics and the quick-win pack (Section 8) live; seed 300 Telegram members from existing communities; prepare the founder story in both languages. T-0: Product Hunt launch (English) the same week as the Telegram channel launch event (Persian) with a live challenge and prizes of Pro founder licenses; the Persian side is the primary bet, the English side the credibility halo. Weeks 1–4 post-launch: daily presence, two AMA sessions, first partner co-branded prep week. Steady state thereafter: the weekly cadence of Section 5.3, one original content piece per week minimum, a quarterly “state of the catalog” note, and a monthly metrics review that reallocates effort across loops based on measured contribution.

> **Growth thesis**
>
> Distribution for DevReady is not an ad budget — it is Persian-language artifacts of effort, shared by learners into the exact communities where future learners already gather, on a cadence the team can sustain without burnout.

6. Monetization Strategy

6.1 The Free-Forever Covenant and the Free/Pro Split

The free tier is a covenant, not a trial: the complete 636-resource library, Daily Challenge with streaks, Roadmap and role paths, Review Deck, local tracking and notes, and JSON export of all local data stay free forever. Three reasons make this the rational foundation rather than generosity: first, curation is the acquisition engine and paywalling it would strangle the top of the funnel; second, the market's price sensitivity and payment friction (Section 6.3) mean a hard paywall would exclude the exact audience the mission targets; third, every competitor's paid tier is a content tier — DevReady's paid tier can be an intelligence tier, which is a much easier ethical sell. Pro sells convenience, capacity and intelligence — never the library.

Table 12. Free versus Pro feature split. The boundary rule: if locking it would harm someone's job hunt, it stays free.

Capability	Free (forever)	Pro
Full resource library and categories	Yes	Yes
Daily Challenge, streaks, Review Deck, roadmap, local tracking, notes	Yes	Yes
Data export (JSON), account deletion	Yes	Yes
Cloud sync across devices	Local only	Yes, unlimited devices
Question bank	Rotating free set (e.g., 25 of 100)	Full bank with model answers and hint ladders
Build-time AI hints and digest cards	Core set	Extended set
AI mock interviews (Phase B)	—	4 sessions/month, then credit top-ups
Readiness analytics deep-dive (trends, weak-topic breakdowns)	Headline score	Full analytics
Company guide deep packs	Standard guides	Interview-loop breakdowns and question sets
Priority Suggest-a-Resource review	48-hour triage like everyone	Fast lane + accepted-credit fast track

6.2 Pricing Tiers and Conversion Logic

Pricing is anchored against verified competitor points (GreatFrontEnd $120/year and $180 lifetime; NeetCode Pro $119/year and $297 lifetime) and undercut meaningfully, because DevReady is the challenger brand and its audience has lower purchasing power. Launch pricing: Pro at $9 per month, $69 per year, and a Founder Lifetime at $149 limited to the first 500 supporters. The lifetime tier is both revenue acceleration and community-building — the 500 founders become the loudest advocates and the most forgiving early adopters. Regional Pro serves Iran-based users at roughly 40–60% of global pricing through local rails (Section 6.3), priced in local currency to remove both the payment barrier and the exchange-rate guessing.

Table 13. Pricing tiers (launch), anchors, and expected conversion logic.

Tier	Price	Anchor and justification	Expected conversion behavior
Free	$0, forever	Competitors' free tiers are samples; DevReady's is the whole library	Wide top-of-funnel; builds trust that powers all later conversion
Pro monthly	$9/mo	Half of GreatFrontEnd ($39/mo); impulse-friendly	Late-stage preppers near interview dates
Pro annual	$69/yr (~$5.75/mo)	Undercuts GFE $120/yr and NeetCode $119/yr by ~40%	Default recommendation; 8–16 week prep cycles fit annual naturally
Founder Lifetime	$149 one-time, first 500	Below GFE lifetime $180 and NeetCode $297	Early believers and diaspora earners; funds the question bank build-out
Regional Pro (Iran-based)	~40–60% of global, local currency	Purchasing-power parity plus local payment rails	Converts users global cards would exclude; identity kept via sync

Conversion expectations are deliberately conservative: 2–4% of active accounts within 12 months of the Pro launch, concentrated in the final four weeks before users' interview dates. The conversion triggers engineered into the product are honest ones: the readiness deep-dive upsell after a mock interview, sync prompts after progress accumulates on two devices, and the mock-interview quota itself. No countdown timers, no crippled free tier, no “you completed this resource — pay to continue” patterns; each of those would trade short-term revenue for the brand asset this plan is built on.

6.3 The Iran Payment Reality, Handled Ethically

International card networks do not process payments for Iran-resident cards, and third-party processors commonly refuse Iranian transactions; this is a hard constraint for any monetization aimed at the core audience. The strategy is to be practical inside the rules: a licensed regional payment partner (ZarinPal-class local gateways operated by an Iranian legal entity) for Regional Pro in local currency; a gift-code distribution model through trusted resellers and community shops for users who prefer that; stablecoin (USDT) as an explicitly opt-in channel for diaspora-adjacent payments where legal; and a sponsored-seat pool funded by the diaspora (“sponsor a prepper”) that gives free Pro to users who cannot pay at all. Two bright lines keep this clean: DevReady will never provide sanctions-evasion guidance, and Regional Pro purchases always run through licensed local entities — the platform itself stays neutral infrastructure. Because the covenant (Section 6.1) keeps

the entire library free, no user is excluded from the product's core value by any of these constraints; payment friction gates convenience, never opportunity.

6.4 B2B: Bootcamps, Companies, and Programs

B2B is the second revenue engine, launched only after consumer Pro validates (month 6+). The beachhead is bootcamps and cohort programs: a per-learner license of roughly $10–15 per term including cohort dashboards (who is active, readiness distribution, completed stages), curriculum mapping onto the roadmap stages, and white-labeled prep weeks (Section 5.4). The second product is a hiring-side signal: opt-in readiness badges that employers can request from candidates, giving companies a cheap pre-screen and giving preppers a reason to keep scores honest. Both products reuse 100% of existing infrastructure — roadmap, challenge, readiness score — so B2B effort is packaging and relationships, not new architecture. The B2B pilot target is two paying cohort partners by month 9; the metric that matters is cohort activation lift, which becomes the sales story.

6.5 Ethical Monetization Principles

- **Never paywall the library,** per the Section 6.1 covenant — the plan's most important sentence.
- **No dark patterns:** cancel in two clicks, no fake scarcity, no shame copy, no pre-checked annual upsell.
- **Hardship pricing exists quietly:** students and anyone who emails get a no-interrogation discount; the sponsored-seat pool covers those who cannot pay.
- **Data is never the product:** no data sale, no ads retargeting users, telemetry aggregate-only (Section 3.2).
- **Public roadmap and honest changelogs** so supporters can see what their money builds — in a market burned by course scams, transparency itself converts.

6.6 Early Experiments Versus Later Scaling

Monetization ships in four deliberate steps, each validating the next. Month 1–2: Founder Lifetime pilot sold manually to the Telegram seed community (tests price and messaging with zero payment-infrastructure cost — invoiced or via early regional rails). Month 3: self-serve Pro with the annual plan as default and Regional Pro through the first local gateway integration. Month 6: B2B pilot with two bootcamps; AI mock interviews enter Pro as the flagship paid capability with hard quotas. Month 12: price review against measured conversion and competitor moves; consider monthly-regional parity and a team tier. Every step has a kill criterion: if lifetime conversion underperforms, tiers simplify

rather than multiply; if regional rails fail compliance review, the sponsored-seat pool absorbs demand instead.

7. 12-Month Technical & Product Roadmap

7.1 Phased Roadmap

The roadmap assumes the small team of Section 7.4 and one organizing principle: each phase must produce either a measured learning or a shippable asset — ideally both. Dates are relative to the plan's approval (October 2026), so “month 3” means January 2027.

Table 14. 12-month phased roadmap by workstream. Q1 = months 1–3, Q2 = months 3–6, H2 = months 6–12.

Phase	Product & engineering	Content	Growth	Monetization
Now (0–4 wks)	Privacy-friendly analytics; Next Best Action card; onboarding quiz; broken-link reporting; PWA install + offline shell; shareable progress card	Start question bank v1 (20 questions); 10 digest cards/week cadence begins	Seed Telegram channel; founder build-in-public starts; 3 Persian SEO landing pages	—
Months 1–3	Accounts + cloud sync (merge engine); readiness score v1; review-due reminders (opt-in); hreflang + FAQ schema	Question bank reaches 60; company guides 1–5; terminology glossary finalized	Launch moment (PH + Telegram); partner-channel collaborations; weekly cadence locked	Founder Lifetime pilot (manual)
Months 3–6	Build-time AI hints shipped for the bank; checkpoint quizzes; notes-to-flashcards; public profile pages (opt-in)	Question bank 100 complete; Persian system-design primer (8 parts); company guides 6–10	Challenge-a-friend; contributor credits live; referral loop on; first co-branded prep week	Self-serve Pro ($9/$69) + Regional Pro via local gateway
Months 6–12	AI mock interviews (quota-based); readiness analytics deep-dive; adaptive rules v1; regional payment rails hardened	Exercises 30; salary/negotiation + relocation guides; digest cards cover top 100; second question-bank tranche (100+)	YouTube mock-interview series; annual data report; K-factor optimization	B2B pilot with 2 bootcamps; founder-lifetime retro; price review

7.2 Metrics and Success Criteria per Phase

Each phase has explicit go/no-go criteria; a phase that misses its metric triggers a diagnosis before the next phase's scope is approved, which is how a small team avoids building on sand. Figure 2 shows the retention trajectory the plan commits to; all numbers are targets pending the month-1 analytics baseline, stated so the team can be held to them.

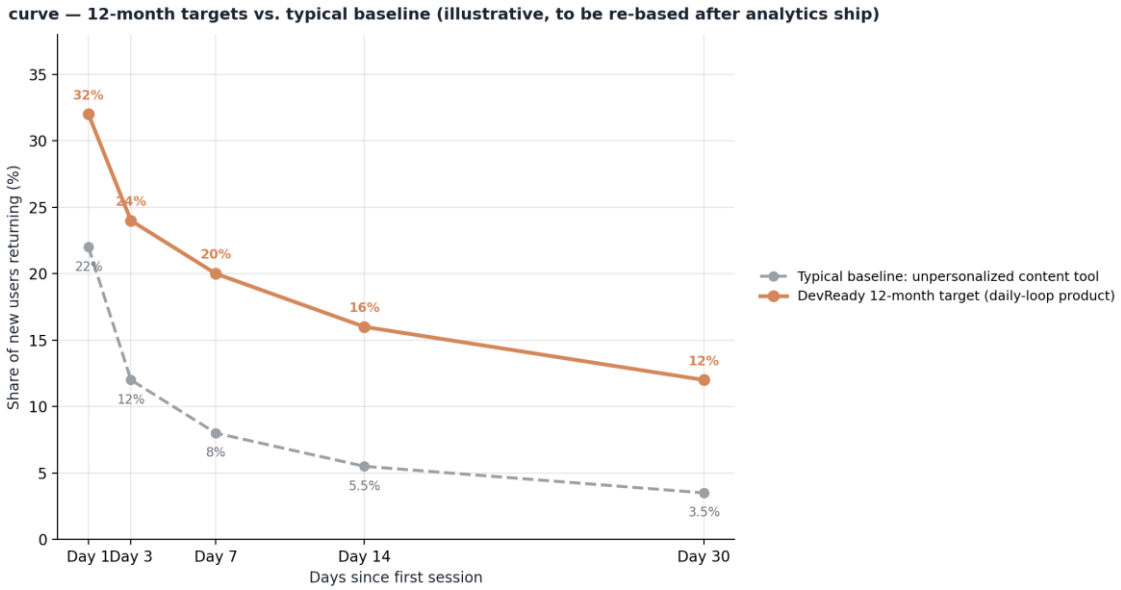


Figure 2. Twelve-month retention targets versus a typical unpersonalized content-tool baseline. Both curves are illustrative; the baseline is re-measured after analytics ship in month 1.

Table 15. Phase gates and success criteria. All baselines are established by the month-1 analytics release.

Phase	Success criteria (go)	Kill / re-scope signals
Now (0–4 wks)	Analytics events flowing; activation measurable; NBA card used by 30%+ of new sessions	Event schema contested or incomplete — delay everything rather than measure garbage
Months 1–3	10%+ of new users create accounts; D7 ≥ 12%; launch drives 1,000+ activated sessions	Account creation under 4% → redesign prompts before adding paid features
Months 3–6	D7 ≥ 15%; 2%+ of accounts on Pro; question-bank completion ≥ 35%	Pro under 1% → revisit Pro value split before B2B
Months 6–12	D30 ≥ 10%; K-factor ≥ 0.15; 2 B2B partners; conversion 2–4%	Mock-interview unit cost exceeds quota revenue → shrink quotas, reroute to build-time AI

7.3 Risks and Mitigations

Table 16. Risk register with mitigation owners implied by workstream.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Link rot degrades catalog trust	High	Medium	Monthly audit job, Wayback fallbacks, digest cards, one-click reporting (4.1)
Iran payment friction caps conversion	High	High	Regional licensed gateway, gift codes, sponsored seats; free covenant keeps core unaffected (6.3)
Runtime AI cost overrun	Medium	Medium	Build-time-first architecture; hard quotas; small-model routing; kill criteria in 7.2
Solo-founder bus factor	Medium	High	Documented playbooks, open catalog-change log, part-time backups per workstream, public roadmap
Persian market ceiling limits scale	Medium	Medium	Dual-market bilingual strategy; English cluster investment from Q2; B2B widens buyers
Competitor copies features	Medium	Low	Moat is corpus + community + bilingual craft (Section 9), not any single feature
iOS PWA limits mute the habit loop	Medium	Medium	Android/desktop first-class; Telegram bot reminders as the iOS stopgap
Community moderation incidents	Low	Medium	Defer open comments; structured reviews only; auditable contributor identities (3.7)

7.4 Team and Resource Assumptions

The plan is sized for: one founding full-stack engineer (full-time), one part-time engineer (20 hrs/week), one native Persian content lead (20 hrs/week, from month 2), and the founder wearing product and growth hats. Fixed costs stay under a few hundred dollars per month at this stage — hosting, domain, e-mail, AI build-time generation batches — with the first material costs being the content lead's time and regional payment integration. Deliberately not hired in year one: a mobile engineer (PWA covers it), a data scientist (rules beat models at this data volume), a designer (the existing design system is a moat to preserve, not escape), and any sales role (founder-led partnerships until B2B proves out). If the Founder Lifetime pilot overperforms, the first hire is a second content lead, because content depth is the bottleneck asset; engineering hires follow only when the roadmap's product phases slip, not before.

> **Operating rhythm**
>
> Weekly: ship log + metrics review (30 minutes, same agenda). Monthly: loop contribution analysis reallocates growth effort. Quarterly: catalog state note, risk register refresh, and a public roadmap update. Small teams do not fail from small budgets; they fail from undisciplined focus.

8. Quick Wins (Can Ship in 2–4 Weeks)

These eight items require minimal engineering, produce visible momentum, and — importantly — are prerequisites or feeders for the main roadmap rather than side quests. They are ranked by expected impact per unit of effort; the top three alone typically move activation visibly because they fix the first session, which is where most products die. Every item reuses existing local state, so nothing here waits on accounts.

Table 17. Quick-win pack, ranked. Effort is in developer-days for the founding engineer.

#	Item	Effort	Expected impact	Notes and dependencies
1	Privacy-friendly analytics (aggregate, opt-in)	3 d	Foundation for everything	Counts, funnels, referrers only; no session replay; ships first
2	Next Best Action card on home	3 d	High — daily habit cue	Rules over local state: due reviews → challenge → next roadmap item
3	Onboarding quiz (role, timeline, hours)	2 d	High — personalizes instantly	Seeds role path, Review Deck, and NBA card; Appendix A.1
4	Shareable progress card (bilingual image)	2 d	High — top-of-funnel loop	Canvas-rendered, RTL-aware; personalization of invite links waits for accounts
5	Broken-link one-click report + freshness badge	1 d	Trust and maintenance signal	Routes into existing Suggest-a-Resource queue
6	Three Persian SEO landing pages	2 d	Organic FA acquisition	Pillar pages for the three Persian head-term clusters (5.2)
7	PWA manifest + install prompt + offline shell	3 d	Habit-loop surface	Second-session install prompt; iOS tested against known limits
8	Interview Readiness Score v0 (local)	2 d	Emotional progress anchor	Local-only preview of Appendix B formula; feedback before accounts

Sequencing note: items 1–3 form a single coherent release in week two, with 4–6 in week three and 7–8 in week four. The pack is small by design; its purpose is to enter the launch window (Section 5.6) with measurement working, the first session improved, and one loop

(sharing) already live — the minimum credible evidence for the bigger account bet that follows.

9. Long-Term Moat (2–3 Years)

9.1 The Compounding Asset Stack

DevReady's defensibility is a stack, not a feature. Layer one is the content corpus: 636 curated entries plus a growing original bilingual question bank, digest cards, and Persian-first primers — thousands of hours of accumulated editorial judgment that cannot be scraped into existence. Layer two is behavioral data: years of (opt-in, aggregate) learning signals — which resources actually precede completed roadmaps, which questions predict interview success — that make the readiness score and recommendations genuinely better over time. Layer three is the community network: contributors with named credits, trusted reviewers, bootcamp relationships, and the Telegram gravitational center, all of which produce a flow of high-intent users no competitor can buy efficiently. Layer four is the brand position: “the serious, honest, bilingual one” — an association earned by restraint and repeated keeping of small promises.

Two assets deserve special emphasis because they are structurally hard to copy. The bilingual AI evaluation dataset (Phase C) — Persian technical answers scored against rubrics — becomes more valuable and more accurate every year a competitor waits to start. And the local-first privacy identity, once publicly adopted by a privacy-conscious audience, cannot be imitated by account-first incumbents without undermining their own business models; DevReady's architecture is its position.

9.2 What a Well-Funded Copycat Would Need to Replicate

Table 18. Replication difficulty from the perspective of a funded English-first competitor (24-month horizon).

Asset	Replication cost	Why it is hard
636-resource curated catalog + rubric process	Months of native editorial work	Curation judgment is tacit knowledge; the rubric and reviewer network are the asset, not the list
Native Persian content corpus (150+ items)	Hire native engineer-writers; 12+ months	Thin talent pool; quality bar set by DevReady's existing corpus
Bilingual product craft (RTL, typography, terminology)	Quarter of focused product work	Easy to do badly; the audience notices instantly and defects
Habit loop data (challenge patterns, review scheduling)	A year of live users	Requires the daily audience first — the chicken DevReady already has

Asset	Replication cost	Why it is hard
Persian community center of gravity (Telegram, contributors)	18–24 months of presence	Trust and credits are non-transferable; incumbents' English brands do not transfer
Bilingual AI evaluation dataset	Start from zero, or never	Only live Persian-answering users generate it; compounding advantage

9.3 Strategic Guardrails

- **Guard the covenant.** The free library is the moat's foundation; any future team that paywalls it has already lost.
- **Guard the tone.** Every growth mechanic must pass the “trusted senior friend” test; growth that damages trust is negative growth.
- **Guard local-first.** Accounts extend the local experience; they never replace it. The anonymous mode must remain fully functional forever.
- **Guard depth over breadth.** A smaller catalog that is alive and trusted beats a bigger one that is rotting; when in doubt, improve before expanding.
- **Guard the bilingual craft.** No machine translation ships under the DevReady name, in content or in AI features.

10. Appendices: Flows, Feature Specs & Metric Definitions

Appendix A. Example User Flows

A.1 First-session onboarding flow

1. Landing (FA or EN by browser locale) → single hero promise + one primary button: “Build my plan.”
2. Three-question quiz: target role, interview window (weeks), self-rated weakest area; optional hours-per-week.
3. Roadmap preview personalized: role path highlighted, stage 1 expanded, estimated weekly rhythm shown honestly.
4. First action in-session: auto-suggested starting resource with a one-tap “Mark in progress.”
5. Daily Challenge invitation: today's question with hint ladder; completion registers the streak.
6. Review Deck seeded from the missed checkpoint items; explanation card shows how spaced repetition works.

7. Soft account prompt only after the first bookmark or completed action (“Keep this progress safe on all devices?”) — dismissible, never blocking.
8. Activation event recorded (bookmark + 1 completion + 1 challenge); if not reached, analytics show where the flow lost the user.

A.2 Local-to-cloud sync and merge flow

1. User signs in via magic link from a second device; server issues account token; local keys enumerated.
2. Local snapshot is serialized (bookmarks, progress, notes, challenge history, review schedule, votes, preferences) with timestamps.
3. Server merges against any existing cloud state: union for sets, newest-wins for scalars, tombstones honored for deletions.
4. Conflicts beyond rules (e.g., divergent notes edited offline on both devices) are surfaced in a simple per-item chooser — the user decides, the system never silently discards.
5. Merged snapshot is written back to both the server and the local store; sync indicator turns green with a human-readable “Last synced 2 minutes ago.”
6. Subsequent changes sync incrementally in the background; offline-first is preserved — the app never waits on the network.
7. Sign-out keeps local data intact and returns the user to full anonymous functionality; export remains one click.

A.3 Referral share flow

1. Trigger: milestone reached (stage completed, 30-day streak) → progress card rendered bilingually with the user's invite link.
2. Share sheet opens natively (Telegram first on RTL/fa, then system targets); card includes a UTM-tagged deep link.
3. Friend lands on a personalized page (“Amir is preparing for frontend interviews — join tonight's challenge”) → Appendix A.1 flow begins.
4. Friend activates per the Section 1 definition → both accounts receive a streak freeze; referrer's counter increments.
5. At 3 activations, the referrer earns a Pro month; at 5, the lifetime 30% annual discount (Section 5.5).
6. K-factor computed weekly from invite-link cohort data; loop variants are A/B tested only when sample sizes allow honest reads.

Appendix B. Interview Readiness Score v1 Specification

Purpose: a single 0–100 number that honestly reflects preparedness for the user's target role, updated daily, computable from local state in v0 and account state in v1. The score is deliberately transparent: every component is user-visible with its contribution, because a number users cannot interrogate is a number they will distrust. Anti-gaming notes: components are normalized against the user's own history rather than absolute counts, streak credit saturates (a 40-day streak adds no more than a 21-day one), and challenge accuracy uses a rolling window so old lucky streaks decay.

Table 19. Readiness Score v1 components and weights (sum = 100).

Component	Weight	Inputs	Rationale
Roadmap completion	30	Completed resources and stages within the active role path	Coverage of the defined surface
Challenge accuracy trend	25	Rolling 21-day accuracy and difficulty mix on Daily Challenge / bank questions	Recency-weighted skill signal
Review discipline	20	Share of due Review Deck cards completed on schedule	Measures retention behavior, not memory
Practice breadth	15	Distinct topics touched in the last 14 days vs. role path topic map	Guards against single-topic tunnel vision
Consistency	10	Active days in the last 21, saturating at 15	Habit strength with a capped, honest ceiling

Formula: score = ∑ (weight × normalized component), where each component is normalized to 0–1 against its own saturation curve (completion ratios for coverage components, recency-weighted accuracy for skill components). The score is always accompanied by the two components with the largest headroom — “your score is 64; review discipline and challenge accuracy are holding it back” — which converts the metric into the Next Best Action (Section 3.3) and closes the loop between analytics and daily behavior.

Appendix C. Metric Definitions

Table 20. Shared metric vocabulary. Single definitions live here and are referenced everywhere else.

Metric	Definition	Notes
Prep action	Completing a resource, finishing a Daily Challenge, completing due Review Deck cards, or adding a note	The atomic unit behind the north star

Metric	Definition	Notes
Weekly Active Prepper (WAP)	Distinct user with 3+ prep actions in a rolling 7-day window	North-star metric (Section 1)
Activation	First session containing bookmark ≥ 1, completion ≥ 1, and 1 finished challenge	Predicts D30; measured per new user
D7 / D30 retention	Share of a first-session cohort returning on day 7 / day 30 (or within ±2-day window)	Both strict-day and window variants reported
Resource completion rate	Resources marked completed ÷ resources marked in progress	Curation quality proxy
Streak persistence	Activated users whose streak reaches 7+ days	Habit anchor health
Review due discipline	Due cards completed within 48 hours of due date	Drives readiness score component
K-factor	Invited users who activate ÷ inviting users, per week	Referral loop efficiency
Free-to-Pro conversion	Active paying accounts ÷ active accounts (30-day window)	Reported with and without lifetime tier
Loop contribution	New activated users attributed to each growth loop	Monthly reallocation input (7.4 rhythm)